

# Understanding by Design (UbD)

*Professional Education*

# Understanding by Design (UbD)

- Framework for developing student achievement
- Understanding-focused, student-centered, standards-driven curriculum
- Goals need to be clarified and assessment designed before planning for classroom activities

# **UbD: Backward Design**

**Stage 1: Identify Desired Results**

**Stage 2: Determine Acceptable Evidence/Assessment**

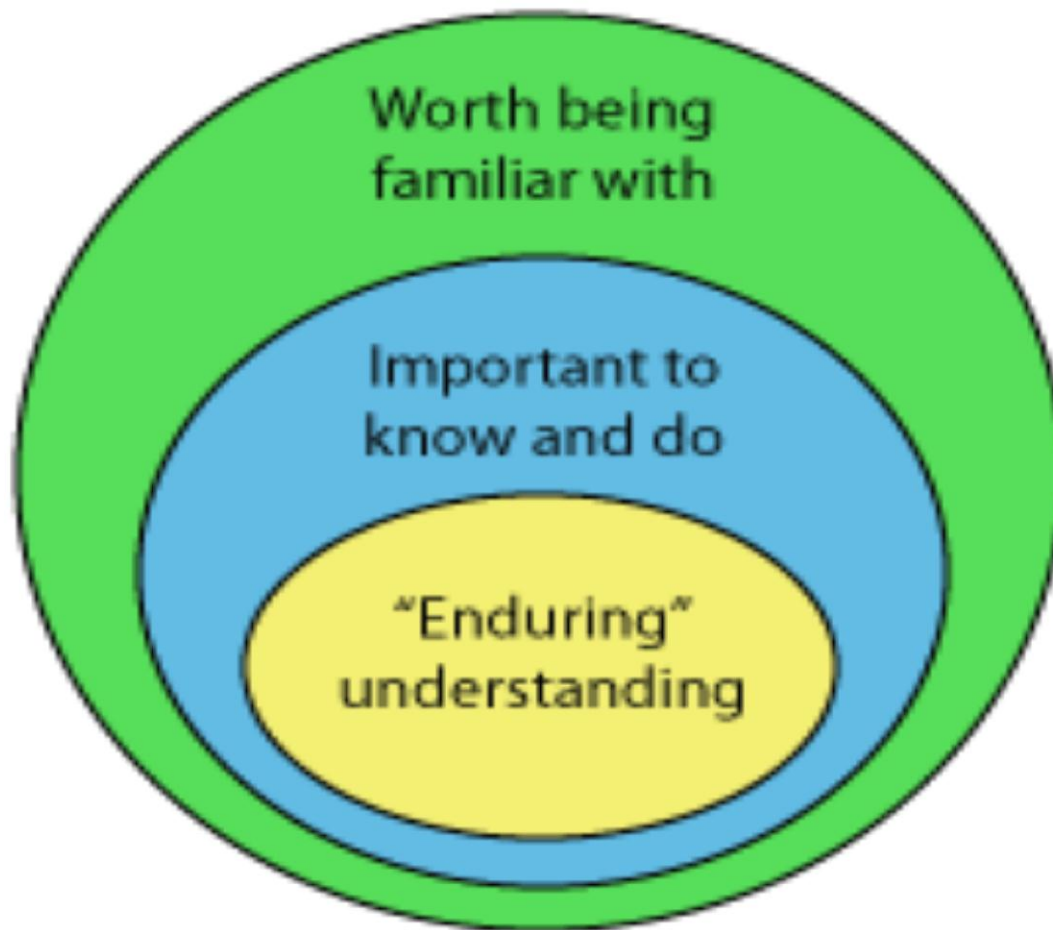
**Stage 3: Plan Learning Experiences and Instruction**

- The first two stages are defined in the curriculum guide (CG), and the last stage is covered in the teaching guide (TG)
- Main tenet of the curriculum: Understanding versus Facts

# STAGE 1: DESIRED RESULTS

- Identification of achievable goals for students

*“To begin with the end in mind means to start with a clear understanding of your destination. It means to know where you’re going so that you better understand where you are now so that the steps you take are always in the right direction (Covey, 1994)”*



Graph of curricular priorities, as discussed in Understanding by Design

# Six Facets of Understanding

- Can explain
- Can interpret
- Can apply
- Has perspective
- Can empathize
- Has self-knowledge



# When we truly understand we:

- Can explain: provide thorough, supported, and justifiable accounts of phenomena, facts, and data
- Can interpret: tell meaningful stories; offer apt translations; provide a revealing historical or personal dimension to ideas and events; make it personal or accessible through images, anecdotes, analogies, and model

# **When we truly understand we:**

- **Can apply: effectively use and adapt what we know in diverse contexts**
- **Have perspective: see and hear points of view through critical eyes and ears; see the big picture**
- **Can empathize: find value in what others might find odd, alien, or implausible; perceive sensitively on the basis of prior direct experience**

# **When we truly understand we:**

**Have self-knowledge: perceive the personal style, prejudices, projections, and habits of mind that both shape and impede our own understanding; we are aware of what we do not understand and why understanding is so hard**

# STAGE 2: ASSESSMENT

**What would we accept as evidence that students have attained the desired understandings and proficiencies - BEFORE - proceeding to plan teaching and learning experiences?**

# STAGE 2: ASSESSMENT

- **Assessment drives instruction.**
- **Teachers should think like assessors before designing specific units and lessons.**
- **Because understanding develops as a result of ongoing inquiry and rethinking, the assessment of understanding should be thought of in terms of a collection of evidence over time instead of an event, a single moment or test at the end of instruction.**

# **STAGE 3: PLAN LEARNING EXPERIENCES AND INSTRUCTION**

- Teachers are required to provide meaningful learning experiences based on the level of understanding of students and to determine whether the goals/desired results have been achieved by following this sequence:
- **EXPLORE-FIRM-UP-DEEPEN-TRANSFER**

# The Big Picture of a Design Approach

| Key Design Question                                                                              | Design Considerations                                                                                                              | Filters (Design Criteria)                                                                                               | What the Final Design Accomplishes                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stage 1. What is worthy and requiring of understanding?                                          | National standards.<br>State standards.<br>District standards.<br>Regional topic opportunities.<br>Teacher expertise and interest. | Enduring ideas.<br>Opportunities for authentic, discipline-based work.<br>Uncoverage.<br>Engaging.                      | Unit framed around enduring understandings and essential questions.                                                                                              |
| Stage 2. What is evidence of understanding?                                                      | Six facets of understanding.<br>Continuum of assessment types.                                                                     | Valid.<br>Reliable.<br>Sufficient.<br>Authentic work.<br>Feasible.<br>Student friendly.                                 | Unit anchored in credible and educationally vital evidence of the desired understandings.                                                                        |
| Stage 3. What learning experiences and teaching promote understanding, interest, and excellence? | Research-based repertoire of learning and teaching strategies.<br>Essential and enabling knowledge and skill.                      | WHERE<br>Where is it going?<br>Hook the students.<br>Explore and equip.<br>Rethink and revise.<br>Exhibit and evaluate. | Coherent learning experiences and teaching that will evoke and develop the desired understandings, promote interest, and make excellent performance more likely. |

# **2010 Secondary Education Curriculum**

- **DepEd Order No. 76, s.2010 dated June 4, 2010 – Policy guidelines on the implementation of the 2010 SEC Refined following the UbD framework**
- **To attain mastery of the subject areas in secondary education**
- **Launched SY 2010-2011 (first year level)**
- **To be progressively mainstreamed following this schedule: SY 2011-2012-Second Year Level; SY 2012-2013 – Third Year Level; SY 2013-2014- Fourth Year Level.**

# 2010 SEC Features

- **Lean – focuses on essential understandings**
- **Sets high expectations (standards-based) expressed in terms of what students should know, do, understand, and transfer in life as evidence of learning**
- **Rich and challenging – provides for a personalized approach to developing the students' multiple intelligences through the provision of special curricular programs**
- **Develops readiness and passion for work and lifelong learning**